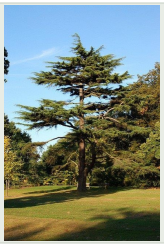
Deodar Cedar

Cedrus deodara

Family: Not stated Also known as: —

GARDENS Rockery: 1 **TOTAL 1**



Summer / form
Library candidate

Not available

Fall color
Not available

Not available

Flower
Not available

Not available

Leaf close-up
Not available

QUICK FACTS & PLANTING

Type: Tree
Evergreen/Deciduous: Evergreen
Mature size: 40–70 ft in cultivation (native habitat to 150+ ft). **Open:** Cultivated height range varies; no tight three-source agreement. × 20–40 ft. Confirmed range by multiple sources.
Hardiness / Zone 8a: Suitable for Zone 8a. Hardy Zones 6–9 (sources vary 6–8/9). Performs in Atlanta with good drainage and protection from extreme wind. Fast growing when young. Prefers full sun. Restart pass (2026-10-13): NC State confirms 30–50 ft, pyramidal when young with pendulous branches, moderately drought and salt tolerant, deer resistant. [https://plants.ces.ncsu.edu/plants/cedrus-deodara/]
Sun: Full sun. Tolerates light shade.
Water: Low to medium once established. Drought tolerant. Prefers well-drained soil.
Soil: Well-drained. Adaptable. Prefers somewhat dry to average moisture. Avoid wet sites.
Growth rate: Not stated
Not stated
Planting:
Siting: Plant in full sun in well-drained soil. Protect from strong winds. Water regularly until established, then drought tolerant. Allow room for spread. Minimal pruning. Suitable as specimen or screen.
Soil prep: Well-drained. Adaptable. Prefers somewhat dry to average moisture. Avoid wet sites.
Depth/spacing: Not stated
Season: Not stated
Establishment: Not stated

ORIGIN, CHARACTERISTICS & HEALTH

Origin / native: Native to the western Himalayas. National tree of Pakistan. Name from Sanskrit “devadaru” (wood of the gods).
Form / habit: Evergreen conifer. Pyramidal when young, becoming broader and flat-topped with age. Pendulous branchlets. Drooping leader. Fast growth when young.
Foliage: None (evergreen).
Flowers / fruit: Not stated
Bark / stem: Dark brown to nearly black. Smooth when young, fissured with age.
Not stated
Health:
Health notes: Possible issues: Seiridium canker, root rot in poor drainage, needle blight, cedar flagging. Generally trouble-free when well-sited. **Open:** Specific Zone 8a incidence is thin.
Not stated
Additional:
- Soft blue-green to gray-green needles. - Gracefully pendulous branchlets. - Upright male cones; barrel-shaped female cones that disintegrate. - Fast growth when young (1–2+ ft/year). - Long-lived.